

General Introduction/Background

- **Tell me about yourself.**

This is a classic icebreaker, often the first question. Prepare a brief overview of your career and key experiences. Keep it concise, tying your work experience to the job description.

Example: "I've spent three years as a bookkeeper, managing accounts payable, receivable, and payroll. I once caught a red flag—discrepancies that saved thousands—and with my CPA certification, I'm ready to excel as your public accountant."

- **What makes you unique?**

Hiring managers want your skills and experience. Reflect on specific examples, like leadership skills or a new skill you've honed, to demonstrate that.

Example: "My ability to exceed deadlines without sacrificing accuracy stands out. In my previous job, I delivered early quarterly reports, earning a promotion."

- **Walk me through your resume.**

This is similar to "Tell me about yourself" but focuses on your work history. Highlight relevant experiences and accomplishments.

Exploring your motivations and fit

Interviewers probe why you're drawn to their company and role, testing your fit within their company culture and teamwork dynamic:

- **Why are you interested in this position? / What interests you about this role?**

Link to the job description. Demonstrate your understanding of the role and your enthusiasm for its challenges and opportunities.

Example: "I love onboarding new hires and creating resources," you might say. "In my current job, I've helped teammates adapt faster, and I'd bring that here."

- **Why are you interested in our company?**

Show that you've researched the company and understand its mission, values, and culture.

Example: "Your eco-friendly tech inspires me. I'm passionate about sustainability and see myself growing in this work environment."

- **Why should we hire you?**

This is your pitch to shine, but you don't need to highlight your career goals here.

Example: "I thrive in fast-paced settings and deliver weekly updates—perfect for your work style," you might say. "My deadline-driven skill set fits your job description, and I'm excited to join your team."

Strengths and Weaknesses

These reveal self-awareness and growth—key for hiring managers:

- **What are your strengths? / What are your greatest strengths?**

Focus on skills that align with the job description and provide specific examples.

Use specific examples.

Example: “I’m a natural leader who thrives under pressure. I’ve exceeded KPIs (Key Performance Indicators) and led diverse teams—skills I’d bring to your operations.”

- **What are your weaknesses? / What is your greatest weakness?**

Show improvement.

Choose a weakness that you are working on improving and explain how you are addressing it.

Example: “As an introvert, I used to avoid team updates. I took a communication skills course and now contribute confidently.”

Planning your career path

Here are some questions like “Where do you see yourself in five years” to gauge ambition and fit:

- **Where do you see yourself in 5 years? / Where do you see yourself?**

Align with the company.

Example: “I aim to lead a design team and streamline processes. Your dynamic work environment would grow my project management skills.”

Show ambition and alignment with the company's growth.

- **What are your goals for the future?**

Tie to the role.

Example: “I want to deepen my marketing expertise,” you might say. “This role’s challenges would pave my career path to leadership.”

Reflecting on past experiences

Your last job typically shows your work ethic and adaptability:

- **What did you like most about your last position?**

Highlight relevance.

Example: "I loved the collaborative atmosphere at my last job. Working on marketing with coworkers honed skills I'd bring here."

- **What did you like least about your last position?**

Focus on growth.

Example: "My previous role had little advancement. I crave challenges, which your role offers."

- **Why did you leave your last job? / Why are you leaving your current job?**

Be honest but professional. Focus on your career progression and future goals.

Look forward.

Example: "I've gained experience, but I'm ready for more responsibility. This role is my next step."

- **What is your greatest accomplishment?**

Highlight a significant achievement that demonstrates your skills and impact.

Tackling tough situations

Behavioral/Situational questions test problem-solving and communication skills. Use the STAR method:

- **Tell me about a time you faced a difficult situation at work.**

Highlight how you found a solution.

Describe the situation, the task you were responsible for, the actions you took, and the positive outcome.

Example: "A key client needed a pitch when my boss was out," you might say. "I reassured them via video, delivered it, and won the account—showing I can handle stressful situations."

- **Describe a time when you had to work with a difficult team member / How do you handle conflict in the workplace?**

Focus on how you approached the situation and resolved the conflict.

Show maturity.

Example: "A coworker lagged due to overlapping projects. I discussed it calmly, adjusted his load with a manager, and he thrived."

- **Give an example of a time you made a mistake.**

Explain what happened, what you learned from the experience, and how you've improved.

Defining success and accomplishments

These may reveal your work ethic:

- **What is your greatest accomplishment?**

Use a realistic example you can prove.

Example: "I doubled social media engagement with a low-budget video," you could say. "It drove conversions, showcasing my creativity."

- **How do you define success?**

Be honest about your accomplishments.

Example: "Success is meeting goals while boosting my team," you might say. "In my previous job, I hit quotas and sped up processes."

Addressing practicalities

These questions are aimed at practical answers:

- **What are your salary expectations? / What are your salary expectations?**

Research the typical salary range for the role and location, and be prepared to discuss it.

Example: "Based on my work experience, I'd expect \$60,000 to \$70,000, but I'm flexible," you might say.

- **Do you have any questions for us?**

Prepare thoughtful questions about the role, the team, or the company to show your engagement. This is your chance to show the research you've already done.

Example: "What challenges might I face?" or "How does teamwork shape success here?"